John Mahood School Council

Meeting Minutes November 20, 2025 at 6:30pm

Present:

In Person:	Online:	Absent:
Linda Cotnam	Katie Armstrong	Meaghan Hachey
Christine Martin	Alicia McGuire	Cait Smith
Mary Blanchard		Laura Fehrenbach
Betheny Metzger		Emily Martin
Leah Cressman		
Stephanie Rempel		
Kacheena Morrison		
Alana Murray		
Tabitha Nicholson		
Darrell Schinkel		
Emily McConnell		
Bryn (student)		

Territorial Acknowledgement - Linda

Discussion of Previous Minutes - (Mary for Laura)

- See last month's minutes here
    - Revisions:
        - Removed Leah Cressman from attendance list (was absent)
    - Accepted as revised by - Bethany
    - Seconded by - Tabitha

Principal's Report - Linda

- Introduce Brynnley (Bryn)
    - Grade 6 student rep, part of the SCIS team - welcome!

- Bullying Awareness and Prevention Plan
    - Adults from SCIS team brainstormed ideas. Teachers added to the Plan. Working document, but very comprehensive of all they're doing.

- Safe, Caring, and Inclusive School (SCIS) Update
    - Door decorating - classrooms have decorated their doors. Council parents will review tonight.

- Also held assemblies and game show.

- School EA Allocation Update
  - Will be hiring another 25-hour EA.
  - Waiting for some reference checks.

- Intramurals at John Mahood
  - Grade 4 to 6 Newcomball now on.
  - Soccer Baseball just finished.
  - Typically grade 4 to 6 as this is when students tend to get disengaged and have some more conflict with peers and so this allows for team play, all can play, etc.

- School Improvement Update
  - Met with School Improvement team - teachers Schnurr, Fraser and Janzen along with admin.
  - Started looking at data and going through the SLIP plan.
  - Will be meeting again in early December and will provide some summaries at the next meeting.

- What We Work Towards activity
  - As you know schools following Board directives and goals like the North Star are expected across the Board.
  - At each staff meeting in addition to various school improvement, equity, or other activities we review these guidelines
  - Sample activity provided to Council to try.

Chair's Report (Mary for Laura)

- PRO Grant - Application due next week ($500 grant)
  - Suggestion for a game lending library discussed at last meeting. Title suggestions were provided by Christine, Bethany.
    - (Action) Mary and/or Linda will ask Leanne for an estimate through approved vendors. Will also explore whether we can purchase from other stores.
    - (Action) Mary will complete the grant for the game lending library.

- Another suggestion was proposed to use the grant to provide Woolwich Counselling Services. It was noted that WCS already offers two programs per school each year. The suggestion was to pay for additional parent mental health programs/workshops. Discussed timing and that there was likely not enough time to coordinate with WCS ahead of grant application. Agreed to consider inviting WCS in January to present on available parent/child sessions.

- Ideas for spending
  - Focus on Nature Workshop: Discussion - Preference to encourage activities out in nature without the cameras. Teachers already do nature activities. No desire to proceed at this time.
  - Words Matter: Discussion - What does the school get from joining the campaign? Additional work for teachers to accommodate and roll out. There may be similarities with what WCS offers. No desire to proceed at this time.
  - Mascot: Discussion - Can range from $6,000 to $10,000. Lots of variation in options (e.g., head vs full costume). Vendors located in GTA. Cost seems high. Not sure what the warranty is, but costumes would be expected to last 10+ years. Could get some options, and have students vote. How often would we use it through the year? Will continue to explore other options and revisit in January.
  - Drumfit: Discussion - Activity where students drum on stability/balance balls. Both musical and physical activity. School gets to keep some of the balls.
    - (Action) Christine will look into pricing.

- Skating Party Update
  - Budget ($700) should be good.
  - Any suggestions for other activities? Scavenger hunt? Colouring? Printed puzzles (sudoku, word hunt, etc.)?

- WRAPSC update
  - Bethany and Leah attended the last meeting. Guest speaker was talking about the use of screens and how they affect developing brains. Challenging the use of screens in school. Encouraged parents about different safety tools on screens.

Teacher's Report (Christine)

- There was a staff vs student soccer baseball game on November 10th against the winning team from intramurals.

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- Saidat came to visit the school, spreading a message of love and kindness.
- Door decorating, poster creation, and special announcements and assemblies for Kindness and Anti-Bullying week (run by the SCIS team).
- Harvey's burger days have started to raise money for Grade 6 camp. Reminder to pre-order online.
- Popcorn Wednesday have started - reminder to pre-order online.
- Remembrance Day assembly went well with classes singing, reading poems, creating art, and had a guest speaker from the Canadian Military.
- Report cards came home on November 18th. Please return the envelope. Any questions, please reach out to your child's teacher.
- Photo retake day was November 20th. Previously ordered photos were sent home on the 19th.
- Bus safety evacuation drills scheduled for November 21st.
- Newcomb ball intramurals started November 20th. There will be a staff vs student game against the winning intramural team.
- Week of Giving
    - Starts December 1 (Mitten Monday, Toiletry Tuesday, Book Wednesday, Toonie Thursday, Food Friday)
- Holiday Assembly is December 18th and will be Comfy Cozy Day.

Student Report (Bryn)

- SCIS has been good experience. Some difficulties working together, but has been a good experience. Really enjoyed the Saidat presentation - it was very fun and loud.

Treasury Report (Katie)

- See Treasurer's Report

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- $6,000 currently unallocated for 2025-2026
- Haven't paid for poinsettias and coffee yet.
- $3,000 to $4,000 to still come in from pizza.

Social Media Report (Katie)

- Remembrance Day post
- Photos of the kids get more engagement
- Reminder about coffee and poinsettia pickup, comfy cozy day, etc.
- Skating party (save the date)
- Will post some photos from the door decorating

Fundraising/Community Engagement (Emily)

- Coffee and Poinsettia fundraiser
    - Coffee and Poinsettas - profit is $1,660
    - Pick up next week (November 26th)

Open Discussion and submitted topics

- Umbrellas not allowed at recess
    - If it's raining, students will not be going outside.
    - If it's light rain/drizzle, no umbrellas allowed during recess as they can be dangerous on the playground.
    - To and from school is ok.

Next Meeting - Thursday January 15th, 2026 6:30pm
Meeting adjourned 8:03pm